



照片提供：員林大潤發

Unit 7: Bookstores are not libraries

RT-Mart has an excellent book section located on the second floor. They have a lot of bestsellers and other popular titles at really reasonable prices. I go there quite a bit because I am a bookworm and am always looking for something new to read.

The books there are displayed on shelves that go up about 8 feet along the wall. I can't reach the books on the top shelf, but if I ask a salesperson, they'll bring out a stepstool and get it down for me. The staff is nice to me because they know that I buy a lot of books from their store.

The books are organized alphabetically by author and put into categories. There is a fiction, a non-fiction, a children's and an educational section. They also have a lot of magazines and comics. As well, you can get school supplies there.

Though the books are for sale, many people seem to think that it is a library. The freeloaders sit on the benches in the middle of the aisle and read books for free. I think it is okay to peruse a book to see if you like it, but reading it with no intention of forking out any cash is another thing altogether. It's really not fair to customers who expect to buy new books, not books that have been partially read by someone that is too cheap to actually pay for it.

I guess that is why some bookstores in Taiwan have to put plastic wrap around their books and magazines. But this only prevents honest customers from being able

to preview books.

If I had a bookstore of my own, I certainly wouldn't tolerate non-paying customers lounging around reading my books. I bet if these kinds of people tried sitting around a clothing store wearing stuff they hadn't paid for, they would get their stingy butts kicked out on the street. Or how about sitting on the floor in a bakery sampling everything? Not likely they would last long there either. So why should a bookstore be any different? In my opinion, it shouldn't.